ETHAN ALDRICH

Chief Technology Officer: Security, Infrastructure and Software Engineering

Security Operations · Network and Systems · Platform Engineering · Full-Stack Development

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SUMMARY

Technology leader and hands-on engineer who owns security operations, the network, and the full software footprint of two Las Vegas companies: a rental car operator with eight locations and 314 employees, and a management group with nine subsidiaries. Sole responder for detection and response across Wazuh, Suricata, and Zeek, with Graylog and Elasticsearch aggregation and Microsoft Defender and Sentinel on the Windows and Azure estate. Own PCI DSS compliance, Active Directory hardening, and network segmentation, holding 99.993% uptime since 2023 on a $750K annual IT budget. Holds a B.S. (September 2026) and an M.S. (October 2026) in Cybersecurity and Information Assurance from WGU.

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security Analytics Professional (CSAP) · CompTIA Security+ · CompTIA CySA+ · CompTIA Secure Infrastructure Specialist (CSIS) · CompTIA Network+ · CompTIA A+ · CompTIA IT Operations Specialist · CompTIA Data+ · CompTIA Project+ · ITIL v4 Foundations

Trade: GMC EV Master, Level 4 Fleet Technician, OSHA forklift and aerial lift.

EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer

Sep 2021 to Present · Las Vegas, NV

Malco Enterprises of Nevada · Budget Rent A Car of Las Vegas

- Own security operations for 314 employees across eight locations as the sole responder: deployed and tuned Wazuh for host intrusion detection, Suricata for network intrusion detection, and Zeek for protocol analysis, with Graylog and Elasticsearch for aggregation and Grafana for visibility.
- Administer Microsoft Defender and Microsoft Sentinel across the Windows and Azure estate: alert triage, investigation, and tuning to suppress false positives without losing signal.
- Own PCI DSS compliance across all payment processing systems: recurring audits, vulnerability remediation cycles, and defense of a live cardholder data environment.
- Own the network end to end: SD-WAN, Cisco IOS, VLAN segmentation, PoE, firewall policy, VPN infrastructure, and intrusion monitoring.
- Administer Active Directory and Group Policy for all 314 users: provisioning, access control, policy hardening, and recurring Active Directory and Microsoft 365 security audits.
- Conduct digital forensic investigation of compromised and suspect endpoints, from acquisition through root-cause write-up.
- Lead technology strategy and operations on a $750K annual IT budget, holding 99.993% uptime since 2023.
- Architected and operate the distributed application stack that replaced paper processes company-wide: digital check-in/check-out at ~5,600 transactions/day, a claims management platform with vehicle lifecycle tracking, digital vehicle inspections, and a rental workflow automation engine, built on Node.js/Express/MongoDB behind Nginx with load balancing on DigitalOcean Kubernetes.
- Built Maverik (C#/.NET), an API wrapper over the mainframe rental platform's Bluezone HLLAPI interface, improving operational efficiency by 85%.
- Run the internal Python service tier: FastAPI APIs, Celery/Redis job queues monitored with Flower, and SQLAlchemy/Alembic schema migrations, with cloud infrastructure managed as code in Terraform and CI/CD across six self-hosted GitHub Actions runners spanning two organizations.
- Built internal Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers putting the rental, fleet-reporting, and rate-management SQL Server databases behind an agent-callable interface.
- Administer Windows and Linux servers, SQL Server with Power BI reporting, the Wizard and WAND rental platforms, and a GLPI-based ITSM practice.

Chief Technology Officer Nov 2021 to Present · Las Vegas, NV

Twelve Management

- Built the complete IT and network infrastructure from the ground up for a management company and nine subsidiaries spanning development, jet charter, and retail.
- Directed cross-functional technical operations for a team of 52, holding system reliability, security, and scalability through a period of rapid organizational growth.
- Established standardized technology practices, security policies, and operational procedures across all subsidiary entities.

Assistant Store Manager Jun 2017 to Sep 2021 · Las Vegas, NV

Starbucks Coffee Company

- Led shift operations, scheduling, inventory, and staff training for a high-volume retail location.

PROJECTS & OPEN SOURCE

Internal MCP Tooling · Python, Model Context Protocol, SQL Server · 2025 to Present

Model Context Protocol servers exposing the Wizard rental, fleet-reporting, and rate-management SQL Server databases to AI agents through a typed tool interface: object and schema search, query explain plans, per-database health checks, and scoped SQL execution, so operational questions get answered without handing out direct database access.

Montr: Distributed Digital Signage · Rust, Node.js/TypeScript · 2025 to Present

Rust playback client and a Node/TypeScript control server driving up to 25 concurrent displays over WebSocket, with an automated multi-platform release pipeline in GitHub Actions. In production across Budget lobby displays.

Yacht Network & AV Integration · UniFi, VLAN segmentation, Starlink · 2025

Full network and AV build on an Ocean Alexander 32E and a Princess Y72: UniFi switching and Wi-Fi, VLAN segmentation, PoE, Control4 integration, and dual-Starlink failover, including fabricated mounts and on-site install.

Proxmox Homelab · 2020 to Present

Multi-node Proxmox VE cluster running dozens of self-hosted services behind Nginx and Tailscale; the proving ground for what later ships at work.

SKILLS

Detection & Monitoring: Wazuh · Suricata · Zeek · Microsoft Defender · Microsoft Sentinel · Graylog · Elasticsearch · Grafana · intrusion monitoring · alert triage and tuning · digital forensics

Security & Compliance: PCI DSS · vulnerability remediation · network segmentation · firewall and VPN policy · Active Directory access control and hardening · Microsoft 365 security posture · DMARC/SPF/DKIM · TLS/SSL · GitHub Security (CodeQL, Dependabot, secret scanning) · GPG-signed commits · security auditing

Networking: SD-WAN · Cisco IOS · VLAN segmentation · UniFi · Firewalls · VPN · DNS/DHCP · PoE · Tailscale

Infrastructure & Cloud: Kubernetes · Docker · Proxmox VE · DigitalOcean · Terraform · S3-compatible object storage · Nginx (reverse proxy, load balancing) · Linux (Ubuntu/Debian/Arch) · Windows Server

Languages: TypeScript · JavaScript · Python · C# · Go · Rust · C/C++ · SQL (T-SQL) · Bash · PowerShell · HTML/CSS

Frameworks & Runtimes: Node.js · Express · React · Next.js · Astro · FastAPI · .NET · TailwindCSS · Vite

Data & Queues: PostgreSQL · MongoDB · Microsoft SQL Server · Redis · Celery · Flower · SQLAlchemy · Alembic · Power BI

Architecture & DevOps: Microservices · event-driven architecture · distributed systems · async job queues · REST API design · GitHub Actions (self-hosted runners, multi-org) · Dependabot · Vitest and Playwright test automation

APIs & Integrations: Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers · Microsoft Graph API · RingCentral · NetSuite · Mailcow

IT Operations & Leadership: ITIL v4 · GLPI ITSM · procurement and vendor evaluation · cross-functional team leadership

Fabrication & Field: welding and metal fabrication · CAD · 3D printing · PoE camera installs (10 sites) · forklift and aerial lift

EDUCATION

Western Governors University: Master of Science, Cybersecurity and Information Assurance October 2026

Western Governors University: Bachelor of Science, Cybersecurity and Information Assurance September 2026

West Career and Technical Academy: High School Diploma, Graphic Design 2015 to 2020